My First Cyber Security Breach

Starring Senior Analyst Megaspy & Hoot





In a school by the mountains, with swings and a slide, lived a very big computer with treasures inside. It held all the names, and the birthdays, and more, of every last kid who came in through the door.



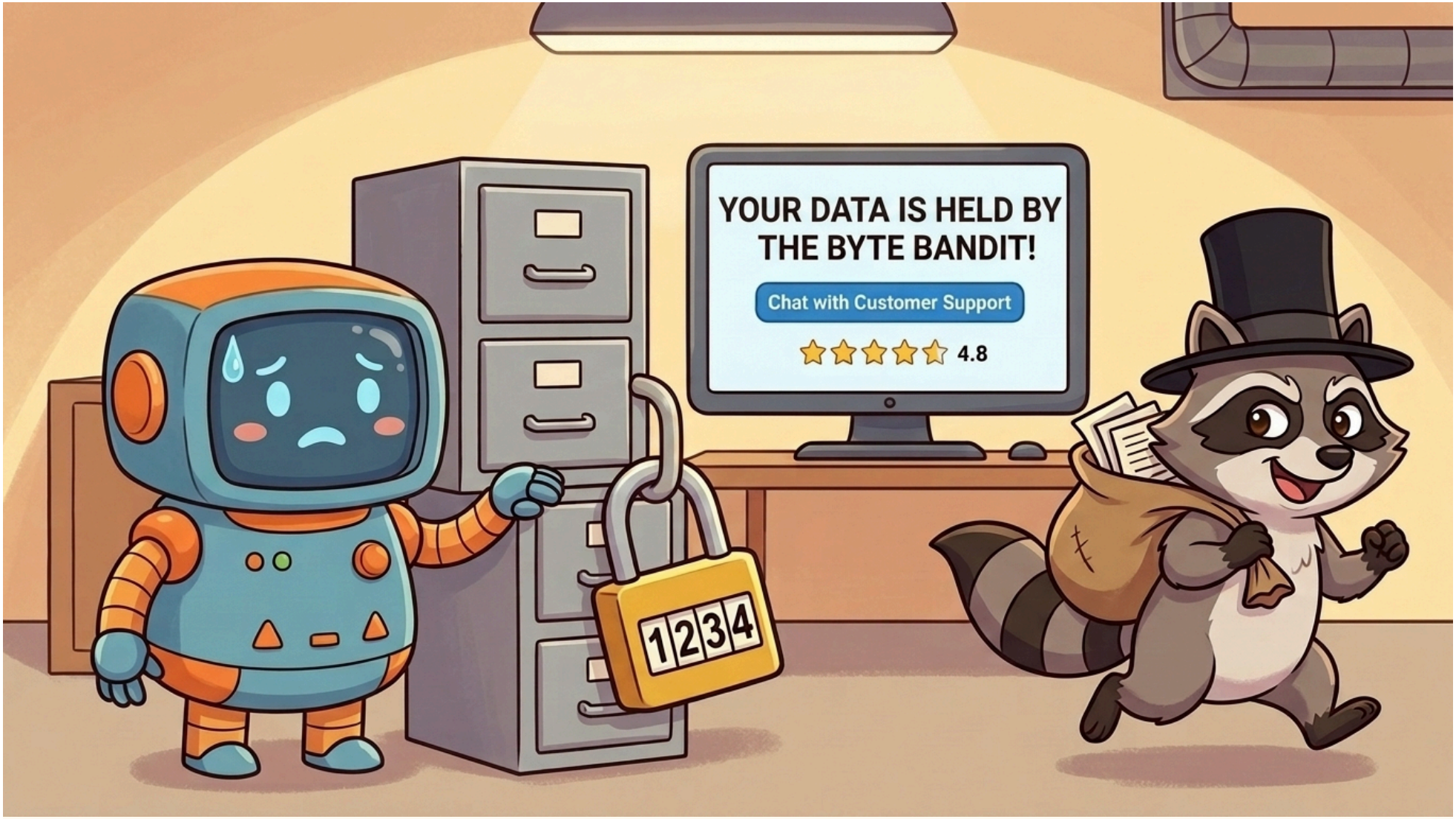
Senior Analyst Megaspy (that's me!) is in Grade Two, I wear a white hat, like the good hackers do. My partner is Hoot, a small owl who can see whatever is sneaky, wherever it be.



But far, far away, in a hat black as night, sat the sneaky Byte Bandit, who schemed out of sight. He didn't want cookies, he didn't want cake, he wanted the files that were easy to take.



He sent the school letters that looked very nice: "Click here for free pizza!" (He sent it out twice.) And one tired helper, with too much to do, clicked on the phishy one, and the Bandit slipped through.



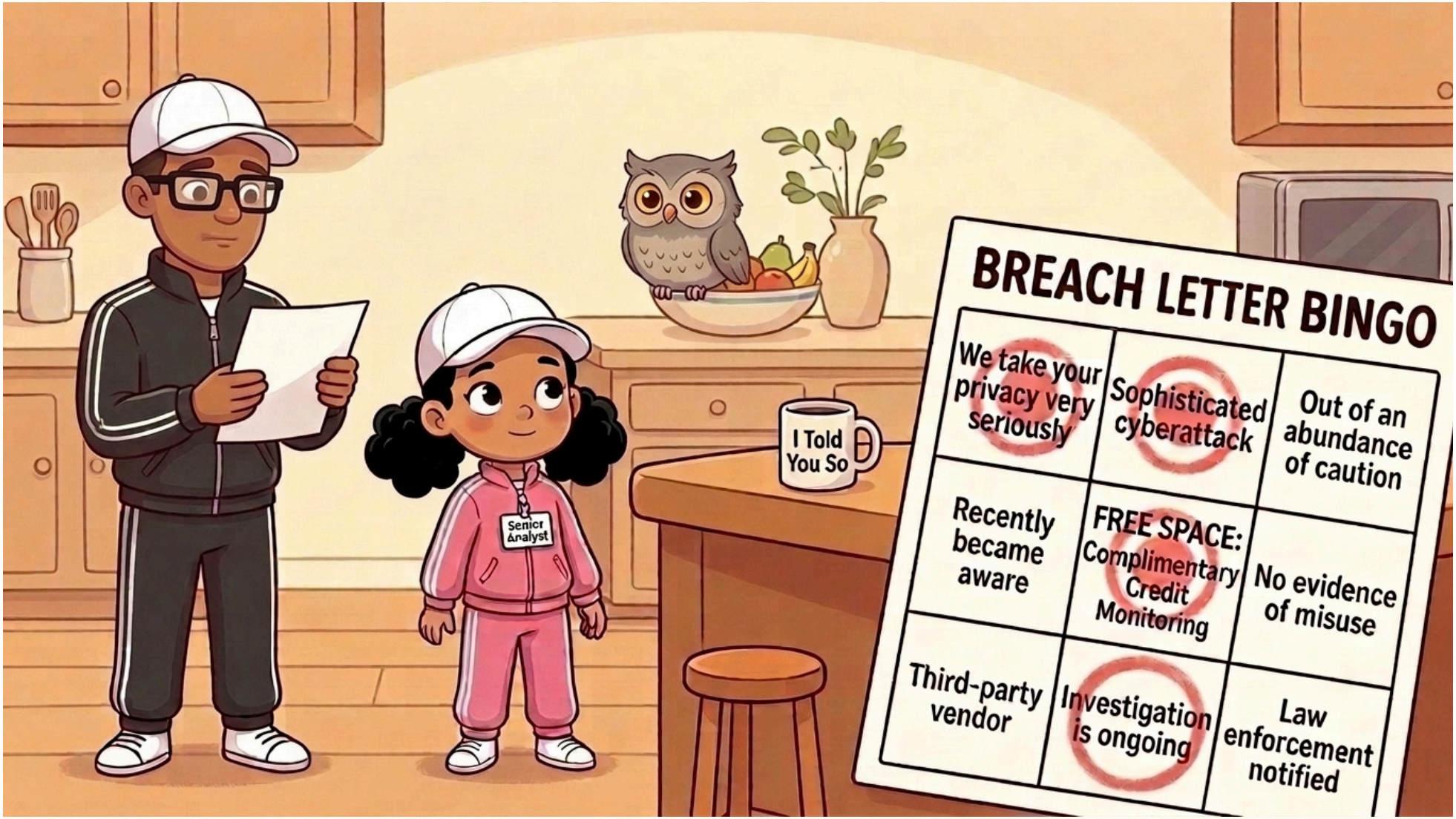
He crept through the hallways of zeros and ones, and copied the papers in bundles and tons. Then CLICK went a padlock as big as a door: "Pay me in treasure, or you'll see them no more!"



The grown-ups woke up and they jumped out of bed. "Call the White Hats!" the principal said. They came with their laptops, their coffee, and snacks, to close all the backdoors and follow the tracks.



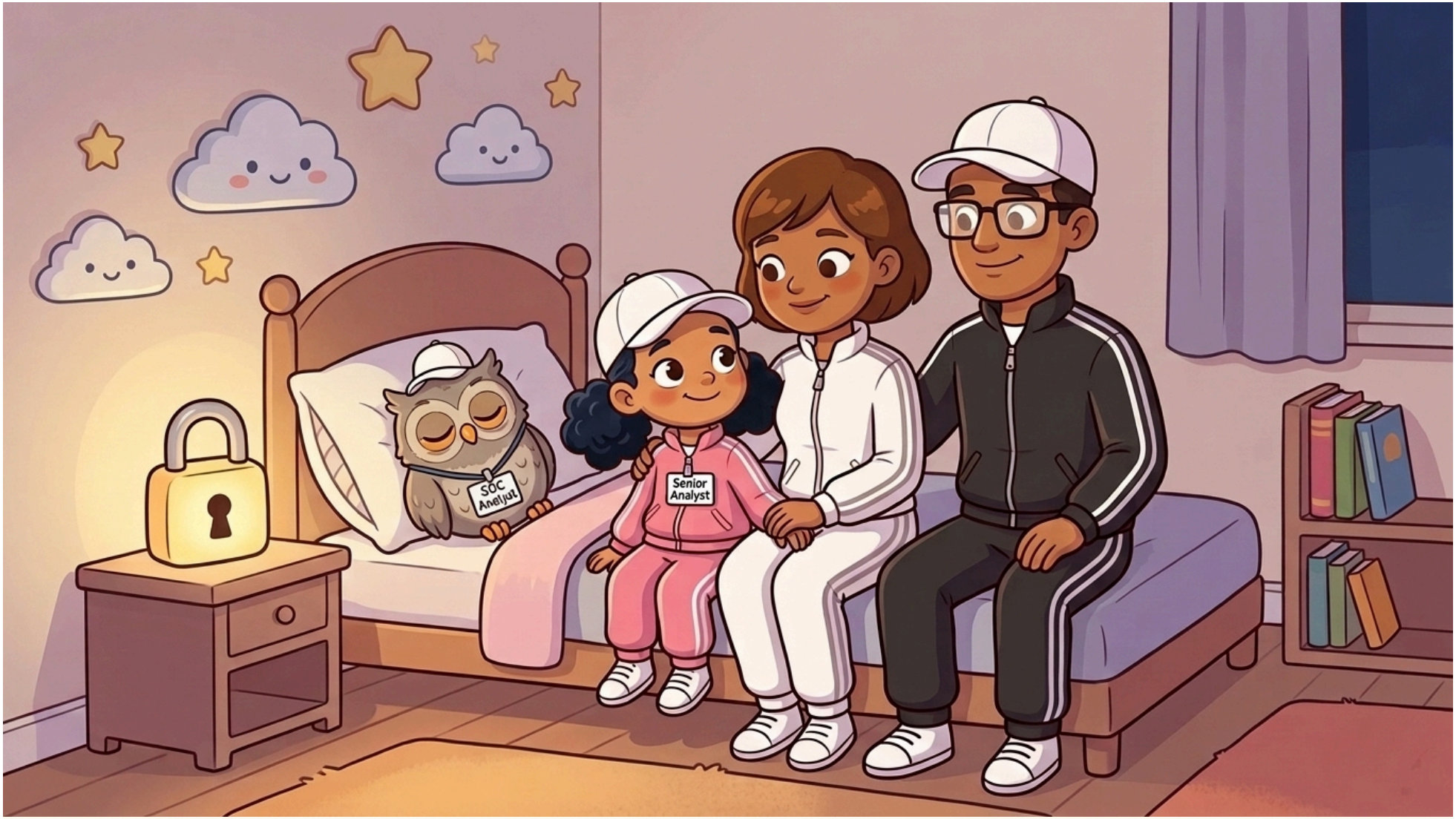
For weeks, things were broken all over the school: the phones wouldn't ring, which was really not cool. No emails, no copies, just paper and pen, till the White Hats said, "Done!" and it all worked again.



A letter came home, and my dad read it twice. He said, "A bad guy took some info. Not nice." "Could we have stopped him?" "This time, we could not. But White Hats learn tricks, and we've got quite a lot."



"What did he take?" "Just some facts about you, like your name and your birthday, and your grade number too. Not your imagination in your dreams, and not your unicorn's colour scheme. The best parts of you were never on their machine!"



That night I felt wobbly, like jelly inside, so I went to find Mom and Dad, and I sat by their side. "When you feel like this, you don't hide it away. Come talk to us any time, any night, any day."



So Dad set up watchers, like owls in a tree, to keep an eye out for that Bandit, you see. If he tries to pretend that he's me at the bank, the owls hoot ALARM, and his plan goes clunk-clank!



Hoot taught me White Hat rules. Here's number one: if something feels weird, it's not time for fun. Go talk to your parents or a grown-up you trust. A White Hat speaks up, 'cause speaking up is a must!



Next rule: if a message seems phishy or strange, like "You won a pony! Click here for your change!", don't click it, don't answer, don't give it your name. A call or a text can be phishy the same! Go show a grown-up. That's how White Hats win the game.



One more rule: your address, your birthday, your school, are treasures to guard. That's a White Hat rule. So before you share them with apps, games, or sites, ask a grown-up first. That's how White Hats win fights.



The Bandit's still out there, but here's what I know: the White Hats are watching, and I'm one, you know! It was my first breach. It won't be my last. But next time I'll spot him, and spot him fast!

Hoot's Cyber Words



Authenticator App
An app on a phone that makes a new code every 30 seconds, so only you can finish logging in.

Backdoor
A hidden way into a computer that a bad guy leaves behind so he can sneak back in.

Black Hat
A bad hacker who breaks in to steal or cause trouble. Like the Byte Bandit.

Credit Freeze / Fraud Alert
Grown-up tools that stop bad guys from opening accounts in your name.

Data Breach
When a bad guy gets into a computer and takes information that's meant to be private.

Hacker
Someone who loves learning about technology and is really good at figuring out how computers work.

Handle
A made-up name we use online to keep our real name private, like Megaspy and Hoot.

Legacy System
A really old computer that everyone's scared to touch.

MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication)
A second lock on your account: after your password, you also need something else, like a code from your phone.

Password Manager
A safe vault that remembers all your passwords for you.

Phishing
A trick message pretending to be someone you trust, so you'll click, answer or share. By text it's "smishing"; by phone call it's "vishing".

Ransomware
Bad software that locks up files and demands treasure to unlock them.

SOC Analyst
A computer guard who watches for trouble all day. That's Hoot's job!

Threat Actor
The grown-up name for a bad guy who attacks computers.

White Hat
A good hacker who finds problems so they can be fixed. White Hats work in cybersecurity, with jobs like Incident Responder, Cyber Threat Intelligence Analyst, Penetration Tester, SOC Analyst and Security Analyst. Like Megaspy and Hoot!

WHITE HAT TRAINING PROGRAM

Certified White Hat

This certifies that the White Hat named below finished training with Hoot and can:

- [ ] I tell a parent when something feels weird
- [ ] I know my family and the White Hats have my back
- [ ] I can spot a phishy message
- [ ] I ask before sharing my name, birthday, or address online
- [ ] I don't chat with strangers in apps or games
- [ ] I only share my passwords with my parents
- [ ] I tell a grown-up if a game asks me for money or info
- [ ] I ask before downloading a game or app
- [ ] I use a made-up name online, called a handle, like Megaspy



White Hat name (handle)

Hoot

Hoot, SOC Analyst

Credential ID: CWH-0001 · Date: _____ · Renewal: read this book again any time! · CPE credits earned: 1 bedtime story

For Grown-Ups: Your Breach Toolkit

British Columbia, Canada · checked October 2026

1. **Take the free credit monitoring**
   offered in the breach letter. Enrol before the deadline.

2. **Put a fraud alert on your credit file**
   Contact both bureaus (an alert at one doesn't carry over): Equifax Canada 1-800-465-7166 and TransUnion Canada 1-800-663-9980, or online. Lenders then have to confirm it's really you. Alerts can last up to six years.

3. **Credit freeze: free in BC from August 1, 2027**
   From then on, all BC residents can get a free credit freeze and free security (fraud) alerts, plus a free credit report and score once a month. Until then, use a fraud alert plus monitoring. (BC Bill 28, 2025: Business Practices and Consumer Protection Amendment Act.)

4. **Check your credit reports**
   from both bureaus. They're free. Look for accounts you didn't open.

5. **Turn on MFA with an authenticator app**
   not text-message codes, for email, banking and anything important.

6. **Use a password manager**
   a different password everywhere, and passkeys where offered.

7. **Phishing comes by email, text and phone**
   Don't use the number or link in the message: hang up and call the number on the back of your card. Forward spam texts to 7726.

8. **Talk to your kids about online safety**
   A weird message is never their fault; they should always show a grown-up. Check the privacy settings in their games and apps, turn off chat with strangers, and keep an eye on what they use. Help for BC families: erase.gov.bc.ca

Report fraud: Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre · 1-888-495-8501 · antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca · and your local police (ask for a file number).

More Cyber Tips for Families

Scan with a grown-up to find kid-friendly privacy and security tips, Hoot's rules, Hoot's Cyber Words, and links for parents in Canada and BC.

github.com/604Security/my-first-cyber-security-breach

My First Cyber Security Breach

WRITTEN BY

Kevin Sahota / 604sec++

CO-CREATED BY

Megaspy

TECHNICAL REVIEWER

Ryan Clarke / 604sec++

ILLUSTRATIONS

Made with Google Gemini, directed by Kevin Sahota and Megaspy

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More tips: github.com/604Security/my-first-cyber-security-breach

Senior Analyst Megaspy and her owl partner Hoot find out what happened when the Byte Bandit broke into the school's big computer.

For ages 5 to retirement.